

On the Trail of the Tiger Killers

JUNE 7, 2010

An exclusive, undercover sting to enter the world of the country's most notorious poaching tribes and know about their motivation, modus operandi, their buyers and the havoc they have caused among the population of India's iconic animal, the tiger.



“Killing the national animal for commercial purposes is a crime against nature and the nation. Those involved, by negligence or connivance, should be punished severely, by a special law if necessary.”

Y.G. CHOUKSEY, *Pune*

Scars and Stripes

Your cover story was thought-provoking (“On the Trail of the Tiger Killers”, June 7). We take pride in counting the number of laws for the protection of wildlife but their enforcement is not carried out properly. We must build awareness for conserving our wildlife and make concerted efforts to protect India's national animal from becoming extinct.

VINOD C. DIXIT, *Ahmedabad*

Your sting operation on tiger killings provided good information. The tragedy with tigers in India is that it takes a lot to maintain a living tiger while a dead one is more lucrative to all concerned. Even Union Minister for Environment and Forests Jairam Ramesh is not



The Ghost of Corruption

A poor record in nabbing the corrupt and getting them convicted is not the bane of Bihar alone but of the entire country (“Well Begun Half Done”, June 7). A basic reorientation that the system needs is to put the onus of proving innocence on those caught red-handed or possessing assets disproportionate to their known means. It skews the balance of equity and is wasteful of time and energy.

BISHAN SAHAI, *via www.indiatoday.in*

The Vigilance Department of Bihar Government has caught nearly 400 government officials and their accomplices on corruption charges but only two have been convicted in the last four years. The law dealing with such officials must be stringent and the guilty should be dismissed.

JAGDISH SAXENA, *Hyderabad*

tough in his actions. A strategy needs to be formulated wherein the Government comes up with a 10-year plan for forests and the wildlife staff. This plan must be supported by adequate funds, and state politicians, public servants, other departments, NGOs and human rights activists must be kept away. No questions should be asked to the assigned forest staff. Only the Union Minister in charge should monitor these activities.

DR A.R. MASLEKAR, *Pune*

Our organisation Aranya has been working with the Pardhis for years now. While a number of people implicated in poaching big cats may have been Pardhis, only a few hunt them. It is true that quite a few rural Pardhis do trap

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